The other addition to the court was twenty-four-year-old Abu'l Fazl, whose father, and elder brother, Faizi, had already been received by Akbar. The precocious young intellectual was initially very loath to join the imperial court, abhorring what he saw as the venality of courtly life and a renouncing of higher intellectual and spiritual pursuits. But Faizi, who had already gained a reputation as a talented poet, as well as Shaikh Mubarak, worked hard to persuade the doubting young man. 'From [Akbar] comes the solution of spiritual and temporal matters,' explained Shaikh Mubarak and indeed under the magnetic influence of Akbar, 'I experienced a bit of relief from that stubborn illness', Abu'l Fazl later wrote, 'which my father, despite his great ability, had been unable to cure.'

As Shaikh Mustafa Gujarati argued with eloquence and fervour for a return to a more perfect idea of Islam before the corruption of the ulema and the beguiling allure of kings, Akbar was creating a new department at Fatehpur Sikri to translate into Persian a whole range of unorthodox texts in Sanskrit, Arabic, and Turki, which would have certainly seemed of highly dubious origin to the beleaguered shaikh.